



FLAT CHAT NEWSLETTER
AUSTIN-HEALEY OWNERS CLUB (NSW) INC
ABN: 87 630 303 136

VOL. 10 ISSUE #12
Dec 2023

COMING EVENTS

DECEMBER

7th Christmas Party & AGM
13th Committee Meeting
25th Santa's Coming

JANUARY

Not Much
10th Committee Meeting

FEBRUARY

1st Monthly meeting
4th Presentation Lunch
7th Committee Meeting

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Saturday Night Fish & Chip Run

Saturday night, the 18th of November, was our end-of-year run to the Berowra Fish Cafe, now named the Water Vista Cafe.

Our meeting point at McDonalds at McGraths Hill was well-attended and by the time we gathered at Berowra, there were 20 members present with family and friends.

The service at the cafe was prompt and the food was great. We were entertained by quite a show of leaping fish in the marina behind us as the light faded. Next time taking a rod and reel might pay off.

Most people chose to return via the ferry, Galston Gorge and the freeway.

Present were: Ray Roberts with Nicole, Glenn, Josh and Kelby House, with friend Ryan, BJ8 Ross and Jenny Penman, BJ8, Allan Whitehouse and Jo Hutton BJ7, George and Liz Goodare 100M, Colin and Geoff Goldsmith MGB, Rod Richards, Neville Stirton, Pamela and Doug Ross, Susie Doctor and Denis Kasza.



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Our monthly meetings are held at Strathfield Golf Club, 52 Weeroona Rd, Strathfield NSW 2135 on the 1st Thursday of each month commencing at 7.30pm.

Members and guests are welcome to join us for dinner in the bistro from 5.30pm.



PRESIDENT'S MESSAGE

Oh! Not the end of another year!

Could it be that global warming is due to the earth moving closer to the sun which in turn results in shortening the time that it takes for Earth to do a rotation around the sun and the reason why time between annual events is now a lot quicker. 2023 almost over is hard to comprehend.

I learned this week that another one of our members, Geoff Golding had passed away on the evening of Wednesday 29th November. Geoff has not been well for a little while now and was suffering from Motor Neurone disease. I first met Geoff 60 years ago when I started work for an insurance company and Geoff was in the same department and across the aisle from where I sat. He was always interested in classic cars, especially Rileys in which he would chauffeur me home on the odd occasion. Our diverging vocations meant that I lost contact until



he purchased an Austin-Healey and joined our club with his wife Carol who both held committee positions many years ago. He is now at peace.

There is more news from Western Australia about the National Rally which you can find on page xxx of this Flat Chat Newsletter and our website providing details of the provisional four-day programme arranged for 22 to 26 August in Geraldton.

Registration for the rally and access to the discounted hotel rates will be available from 31st January and I or the webmaster will

let you know once they have been released.

Several members have indicated that they are attending and if you would like to let others know that you're attending and how you will get there I'll put it on the national rally page of our website. This may encourage others to do the same or even join you in your travels.

Finally for 2023 I will especially thank the committee members, including those that co-ordinate the activities of the chapters, that have

Cont' page 8

COMMITTEE LIST - 2023

Club Patron—Ross Bond

President - Jim Phillips
8 Belina Ave.,
Wyoming NSW 2250
0413 589 306
jpjimbeau@gmail.com

Vice-President - Geoff Smith
0458 777 339
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(Inc Conditional Registration)
Please send all Conditional Registration documents to Patrick's postal address at left

Public Relations - Ross Penman
0408 465 547
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0413 589 306
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Non-Committee Positions
CSCA Delegate - Colin Goldsmith

Librarian - Ronnie Strange

CMC Delegates - Ray Roberts
Greg Strange

Welfare Officer - Pamela Ross 0408 201 226

Display Day Coordinators - Ross & Jenny Penman

Conditional Registration Inspectors - Neville Stirtion
0414 472 877
Geoff Smith
0458 777 339

Assn of British Car Clubs Reps - Christine Lyttle

National Assn Delegates - Gordon Lynas & Jim Phillips

AHOC Life Members - Don Read (D), Alan Jones (D),
Warwick Sell (D), Joe Armour, Christine Lyttle, Patrick
Quinn, Terry Bancroft (D), Ray Roberts and David Mould.

If you want to send something by post, the
Club's address is:-

AHOC (NSW) Inc
PO Box 2754
North Parramatta NSW 1750

It would be appreciated if there were no phone calls to committee members after 9:00 PM.

EXHAUST LEAKS



By Patrick Quinn
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0417 673 065
p.cquinn@outlook.com

Greetings and welcome to the December 2023 issue of the Flat Chat Newsletter which is of course the last for the year.

I must say that as far as member longevity is concerned, 2023 has not been a good year. Just a few days back, President Jim mentioned to me that we have lost six club members throughout the year, including two life members. Very sad indeed!

So what's in this issue? Of course, all those wonderful segments that you know and love(?). Committee reports and yes the minutes followed by what's been happening in the chapters. The cover story concerns the Fish and Chip run to Berowra Waters that appears to be enjoyed by everyone.

I would like to express thanks to those members who took the trouble to send in a few words. This includes Ian Richter for keeping us informed on Maude's progress, John Thornton for

letting us know a little about the history of the BN2 owned by Dennis Norton, photos from Will Sherman welcoming home his 3000 Mk2 Roadster plus a couple of articles by someone who perhaps should remain nameless. As to the future there is an update on next year's Charlie's Run, plus what's planned for the Illawarra/Southern Highlands Chapter for 2024 as well as news from WA on the 2024 National Rally planned for Geraldton.

If going on the below photo you think I am cobbling together a Cyberman for a forthcoming episode of Doctor Who you're wrong, although it does bring a memory of one. No it's an example of overengineering by the Donald Healey Motor Company. It's the gearbox tunnel from the Quinn Austin-Healey which I decided to give a good clean with a paint or polish as was needed. There six pieces altogether, but most are complicated.



The first piece behind the engine is in alloy that's made up from five separate pieces welded or riveted together. The next piece is in steel that looks like it's been hand-formed over a buck. The holes are for the gearstick and gearbox dipstick. The third piece is also in steel that has been made up from 18 separate pieces bent into shape and welded together. The final three pieces are in alloy with the one standing up on the right, covers a hole in the driver's side footwell directly over the clutch slave-cylinder.

I trust you enjoy this issue of the Flat Chat Newsletter and yes there will be a January 2024 issue, so sharpen up your typing fingers and let your fellow members know what you have been up to.

To finish, both Caroline and I wish everyone a wonderful and joyous Christmas and an exceptional New Year.

Monthly Meetings - Zoom ID 980 9019 7648 Passcode 336164

We meet on the first Thursday of the month at Strathfield Golf Club

Weeroona Rd, Strathfield. Starting at 7.30pm or enjoy dinner from 5.30pm

Vale Geoff Golding AHOC Member

It is with sadness that we mark the death of AHOC member Geoff Golding.

Geoff and Carol Golding joined the AHOC in January 2006 with a 100. It didn't take long before they took a deep interest in the club with Carol becoming Social Secretary and Geoff the Technical Officer.

Geoff had a long history with older cars with a brace of MGs and Rileys occupying space in the Golding garage.

After a career within the insurance/finance industry, Geoff and Carol sought a change of scenery and moved to the South Island of New Zealand, taking their 100 with them. While there, they interacted with the Austin-Healey Car Club of New Zealand and returning to their roots, purchased and enjoyed a Riley Elf.



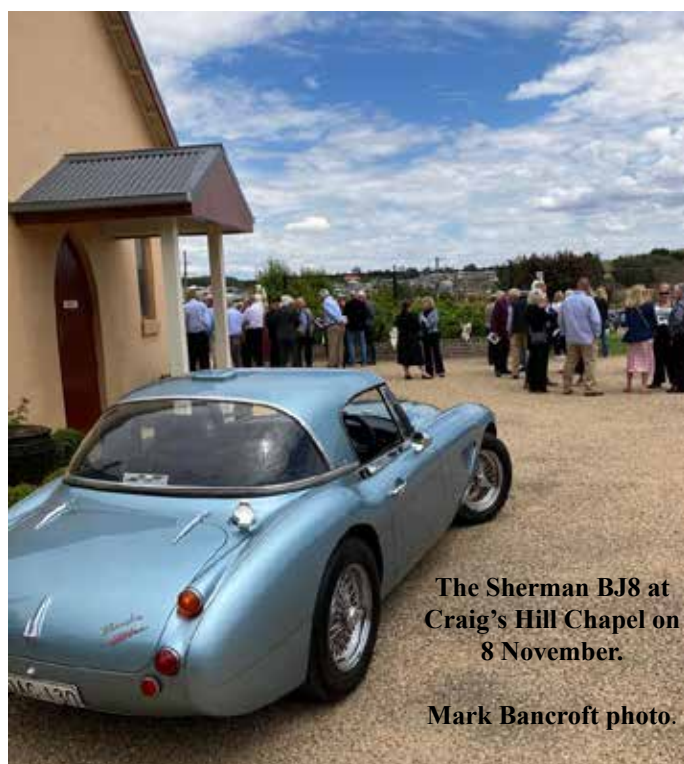
About three years back Geoff and Carol returned to Australia, settling in the Southern Highlands. Unfortunately, after what promised to be a life in peaceful seclusion, Geoff was diagnosed with motor neurone disease ultimately resulting in him going into care.

Sadly Geoff died on Wednesday 29 November.

Our condolences to Carol and family.

Don Read 23-4-1938 - 26-10-2023

In last month's Flat Chat Newsletter the sad news was passed on concerning the death of life member Don Read on Thursday 26 October while in care at Goulburn.



The Sherman BJ8 at
Craig's Hill Chapel on
8 November.

Mark Bancroft photo.

On Wednesday 8 November, family and friends gathered at Craig's Hill Chapel, North Goulburn where we heard eulogies from brother-in-law Keith Drake, family members, a representative of the Vintage Speedcar Association of NSW and our own John Sherman.

Following the service, attendees retired to the Goulburn Soldiers Club to reminisce on their memories of Don.

In the last Flat Chat the invitation was passed on to those who wished to provide their memories of Don.

Thanks to Keith Drake for the following.

Don Read was born on 23rd April 1938, the first child of William and Mavis. In the following years brother Neville was born, then sister Joan.

After a childhood in the Rozelle/Drummoyne area it was clear that he loved anything to do with wheels, motor bikes and cars. Understandably the motor bike stage was a worry to his parents and there was at least one incident where he ended up hospital overnight in hospital. Then came the Speedway, a speedcar and competing. Another great worry for his



Don Read cont'

parents especially when there was several incidents that he ended up upside down on a race track. Don used to say 'I was fine because I always landed on my head'.

Like most young men of the 50's and 60's Don did National Service training at Holsworthy Barracks. He loved his time doing National Service and firmly believed the scheme should have continued. Don was very patriotic, loved his country and was very loyal.

Don was never outspoken; however, he was quietly determined in the way he lived his life. He didn't drink, smoke, or swear, but was happy to go to the pub and socialise.

In 1969 Don was a founding of the Austin-Healey Owners Club and was also instrumental in forming the NSW Vintage Speedway Club in 1983.

In 1972 Don purchased his first home in Wentworthville and in November 1974 married Anne Richardson. During the many happy years at Wentworthville, their home was always an open, where they hosted many Austin-Healey and other functions. There was always an Australian flag in his front yard.

In 2006 Don and Anne realised their dream to move into their new home that they had built at Tallong. Their open-door policy continued as they hosted many events while the Australian flag flew proudly in their front yard.

Don and Anne were married for more than 45 years and were inseparable. When Anne passed away three years ago we all knew life was going to be very difficult for Don. He tried very hard to move forward but had health problems and eventually moved into Warrigal Aged Care in Goulburn. There AHOC members Alan and Vicki Mitchell oversaw Don's his stay at Warrigal, his medical appointments, business and general matters.

Thanks to Rob Harrison

I'd like to say a few words about Don.

Ross Bond, David Mould, Warwick Sell and Don

Read were the first Austin-Healey owners I knew before the club was formed.

I don't think Don had a bad word about anyone he knew.

I remember he got on extremely well with my father and I'd often arrive home and find Don in the lounge room in deep discussion with dad. They were both fiercely patriotic and AHOC club member would know, he always had the Australian flag flying outside his home with Anne.

It's sad to think Don died close to Kenmore in Goulburn as the Kenmore Hospital was where my father spent time after four years in the New Guinea jungle during the war. Dad was in a bad way according to my brother Jon. I had not been born back then.

No doubt Don is up there renewing a further deep conversation with my father, with his wonderful "singing" voice.

Rest in peace dear Don and you will, as you were a good man.

Cheers Rob

Thanks to Ray Roberts

ONE OF MY BEST DAYS

It is 1972, my father, mother, Muriel, I and our three girls are socialising in our backyard at 10 Blue Gum Road when suddenly we are interrupted by four people charging up our driveway. Gees we do not need any visit from Jehovah Witnesses.

Head one speaks up "I notice you have an Austin-Healey" (that's their normal opening) "Yeah" I say, and know what is coming next.

"I am brother Don, brother Keith, sister Anne and sister Joan".

BUT NO - head one says "I have a 100/6 Austin-Healey, we are Don and Anne Read - with sister Joan and brother in-law Keith Drake.

Anne & I are from No 7 Blue Gum, we have bought Tarzan's house. Tarzan was a nick name for a neigh-

Don Read cont'

bour, built like Arnold Schwarzenegger who swung by rope to cut the giant gums at No 7 but had a bad fall and needed to sell up to care for his disability.

Don said, "We have been searching for your car we would hear it pass often, but by the time we ran out front to get your attention you were gone. You should join the Austin-Healey Owners Club."

"I am already a member but do not go to anything as the member age is early 20's and I'm 34."

Anne got the job to get us involved and this was the start of a wonderful friendship.

Photos courtesy Ray Roberts

I met most Austin-Healey people at the halfway houses of Anne and Don, mainly Alan Jones and Kevin Gardner, Chris Lyttle. Met people like Donald Healey, Ross Bond, Karl Stecker, Barry Darley, SA. members - VIC members - QLD members - USA members.

If I did not meet you at Anne and Don Reads, then I have not met you yet.

When Anne and Don moved from Blue Gum Road to Tallong our social life downsized.

We miss you Don and Anne Read

Don's Cars

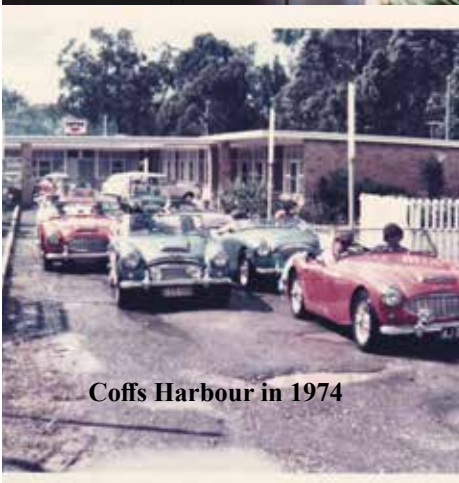
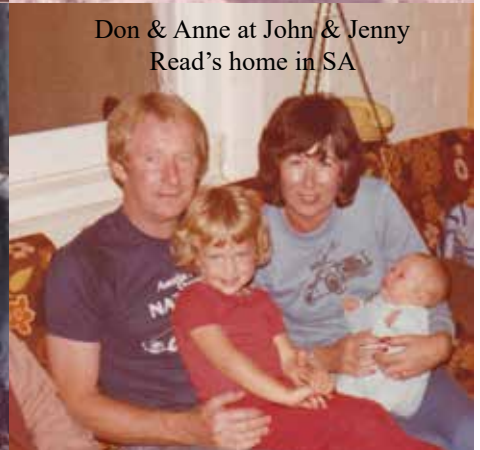


Don with Ray & Nicole Roberts



Don with Roger Elsworthy

Don & Anne at John & Jenny Read's home in SA



Coffs Harbour in 1974



AHOC Girls

Minutes of the General Meeting

Thursday, 2 November 2023

Meeting commenced at 7:40pm.

Venue - Strahfield Golf Club and Zoom

ATTENDEES

Joe Armour, Patricia Bancroft, Natalie & Vince Cessario, Mal French, Colin Goldsmith, George Goodare, Chris Hatch (Z), Richard Horwood, Dennis Kasza, Amer Khoury, Peter Laurantus, Dianne Lawlor, Julie & Garry Lee, Alan Mitchell, Jenny & Ross Penman, Jim Phillips, Patrick Quinn (Z), Rod Richards, Ian Richter (Z), Ray Roberts, Colin Rule, John & Judy Sherman, Geoff Smith, Neville Stirton, Greg Strange, Ronnie Strange, John Thornton, Allan Whitehouse.

VISITORS & NEW MEMBERS

Nagy Khoury, David Stevenson

APOLOGIES

Mark & Gabby Bancroft, Bruce Ewan, Gordon & Louise Lynas, Muriel Roberts

MINUTES

Resolved that the minutes of the General Meeting held 5 October 2023, as published in the November 2023 issue of Flat Chat, be verified as a correct record of that meeting.

PRESIDENT'S REPORT

- Jim referred to the very sad passing of Life Member Don Read and the many tributes posted on the Club's Facebook account. He also confirmed details for Don's funeral. Members planning on attending in an Austin-Healey were asked to let Alan Mitchell know.
- Anyone planning on putting their hand up for a Committee position in 2024 was encouraged to fill in the nomination form ahead of the AGM.
- RSVPs for the Club's Christmas Party on 7 December could be done on the website.
- Jim also gave a brief background on the planned biography of the Club's patron, Ross Bond.

VICE-PRESIDENT'S REPORT

Geoff made everyone jealous by giving a rundown on his recent Italian sojourn!

SECRETARY'S REPORT

There'd been the usual bunch of electronic magazines received from other Clubs. An email had also come in with some parts for sale, so details would be going into Flat Chat. A very detailed request had also been received for a 1956 BRG Healey to attend a funeral service in Wollongong for the passing of Ken Tubman, who had formerly raced a 100. (NB not the one below!).



TREASURER'S REPORT

Jenny gave an update on all things financial.

Main Account	\$35,578.06
Debit Card	\$303.82
Term Deposit	\$70,000.00
Cash Reserve Acc	\$22,190.13
Charlie's Run Acc	\$2,894.17
Total Funds	
Exc Charlie's Run	\$128,072.01

We Received

Membership	\$230.00
Regalia	\$400.00
Interest	\$2,830.11

We Paid Out

InDesign Software	\$89.97
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MEMBERSHIP

No report.

SOCIAL SECRETARIES' REPORT

John Thornton provided a taster of his planned calendar of events for the Illawarra & Southern Highlands Chapter in 2024. In the eight months since they'd started holding events, the Chapter had attracted 170 attendees, which John was pretty pleased with!

Denis Kasza and Colin Rule also talked about upcoming Sydney and Central Coast events, plus on behalf of the Central West Chapter, the Terribly British Day in Queanbeyan.

Jim thanked all the chapter organisers for the great work they'd been doing over the course of the year.

WEBMASTER'S REPORT

Jim reminded members that they could RSVP to the Christmas Party on the website.



WELFARE OFFICER'S REPORT

Pamela had sent a condolence card to Joan and Keith Drake (re Don Read).

EDITOR'S REPORT

Patrick highlighted some of the content in Flat Chat, which had gone out the previous evening. Sadly, this included tributes for the passing of Don Read and former member Gordon Fryer.

REGISTRAR



Patrick gave an update on conditional registration activity, with there being a total of 236 cars on

historic and one car on Classic registration (which involved a lot more work than the cars on Historic!)

HISTORIAN

Joe reached into his huge store of knowledge and memories for some stories about Don Read and Gordon Fryer. He'd first met Don before the AHOC even existed, so had known him for a very long time.

LIBRARIAN

Nothing to report.

TECHNICAL OFFICER/CLUB EQUIPMENT/ SPARE PARTS

Nothing to report.

PUBLIC RELATIONS REPORT

Nothing to report.

CMC REPORT

Nothing to report.

ASSOCIATION OF BRITISH CAR CLUBS

No report.

CSCA REPORT

Colin didn't yet have the 2024 calendar, but he thought it likely there might only be four or five events, with the first being the Sprite Club event at Eastern Creek in January. There was lots of work happening at Wakefield Park – Alan Mitchell advised it was supposed to be reopening at the end of 2024.



REGALIA

Colin had a table full of goodies for sale, as usual. Not for sale was a very well-travelled regalia sign which had been made by Terry and Patricia Bancroft-

In the slightly more stylish category, he had genuine leather sleeves for car logbooks for \$35. He also displayed a sample shroud cover which could be customised with the Club's logo, but there were no takers.

SHOW & TELL

Ray Roberts, as usual, had a couple of stories to tell, including a very dodgy ad!

FOR SALE OR WANTED

- Amer had a warning tale about installing a new steering box only to find out that it was unfortunately twisted.
- As advertised in Flat Chat, Honest Terry's Used Car Emporium (closing down sale), had three beautiful cars looking for their new homes.



GENERAL BUSINESS

Patricia Bancroft talked about joining the Club in 1982 with Terry and in trying to raise money – she'd paid the price for a ride in a company car which turned out to be a hearse!

Meeting concluded at 9.10pm.

Pres Message cont'

given of their time to ensure that our club functions. For me it has been great working with them and I'm sure that you appreciate their efforts. You can get an update of what they have got up to from the report accompanying the papers for the AGM.

Thanks also to those who attend our monthly meetings and endure the disconnect with our Zoom meetings. The committee is currently looking for assistance in how to do these meetings in an improved

fashion and hopefully you will see the results next year.

May the season be a time when you are able to enjoy friendship and fellowship with your family and friends.

Jim Phillips
President



An interesting photo taken in the San Francisco Bay area during the late 1950s showing MGs, Morris and Austin-Healeys. All 100/6s as they have front drum brakes.



Social Report

Bruce Ewan 0432 096 493
Bruce.ewan1@gmail.com

Denis Kasza 0407 492 008
deniskasza@gmail.com

Being December, it is that time of year where many of us say Merry Christmas and Happy New Year. It is that time where we come together to celebrate, have fun and put the year behind us.

Over the last few years, membership for the Austin-Healey Club of NSW has grown. Over this time Covid, lockdowns, restrictions on movement and more have been implemented for the first time since the Spanish flu in 1919.

These last few elements have led to the creation of chapters outside the Sydney metropolitan area that allow members to come together, engage and meet without having to travel huge distances. Attendance for the chapters plus the number of events and diversity have grown.

A special thanks has to go out to Denis Kasza, Colin Rule, John Thornton and Phil Lorking.

The Christmas Party will be held Thursday 7th of December at Strathfield Gold Club. Attendance to the Christmas Party is subsidised by the AHOC. Photos and details to come post event.

Next year will kick off with our annual Presentation Lunch scheduled for Sunday, February 4th. This is a subsidised event.

Presentation Lunch

Date: Sunday February 4th

Venue: 20 Siletta Rd, Niagara Park

Time: Arrival from 11am with a catered lunch to be served (Do not arrive before 11am)

Further details published on the AHOC website.

I will not be standing for re-election as Social Secretary at the next Annual General Meeting. The club is strong and plans for 2024 are mostly cemented in place. Once again that dreaded word Covid is coming into play. In my case as we put this insidious plague behind us, I will be returning to my regular schedule. This means excessive volumes of travel, a lot of which is international.

There are members willing to step forward and fulfil the role.

Given the number of chapters, the scale and range of events, general and committee meeting plus more, it is too much for one person and therefore I will still operate in the background helping and assisting in creating, delivering and planning get togethers for the club.

Have a very Merry Christmas, a fantastic summer break. Wishing all a very happy New Year.

Membership Report -

Christine Lyttle
membership@austinhealeynsw.com.au

Well, where did 2023 go? The years are sure going by very fast now!

We have one new member this month. A big welcome to Andrew Stevenson of Forestville with a BJ8. I am sure you will enjoy your membership, and look forward to seeing you at a club event.

Lincoln and Karina Sell have rejoined and indicated they would like to come along to some more events, we do hope to see you both in 2024!

We had some more sad news advising that club

member Geoff Golding passed away on 29 November 2023. We send our condolences to Carol and the family.

Sending our best wishes to Vince Cessario as he has been in hospital a couple of times during the last month, we trust you are at home recuperating and hope to see you in 2024!

Our Club Christmas Party and Annual General Meeting is on Thursday 7 December 2023 so hope to see you there!

Wishing you all a very Merry Christmas and a Happy New Year and we do hope to see you at an event in 2024!



AUSTIN HEALEY NATIONAL RALLY GERALDTON 2024

22 TO 26 AUGUST

Wildflower Country Provisional Program

Thursday 22nd August

- * 2 to 5pm – Registration at the Ocean Centre Hotel (OCH).
- * From 5.30pm—Sunset Evening at the Geraldton Yacht Club (GYC), Meet & greet while the Sun sinks into the ocean at 6.03pm. Casual/ Come as you are for drinks and share food. (350m walk from OCH)

Friday 23rd August

- * 6am to 8.30am – Breakfast at your Hotel.
- * Mid to late morning – Display at the City's Foreshore, cafés and shops close by.
- * Afternoon – Visit the HMAS Sydney Memorial and Batavia Museum
- * 7.30pm till late Farmers & Fishers (Dress Up) themed Dinner at Gybes (GYC) – Bring your dancing shoes! (350m walk from OCH)

Saturday 24th August

- * 6am to 8.00am – Breakfast at your Hotel.
- * 8.45am – Depart for Mullewa (99km) for the Agricultural Show where our cars will be on display.
- * 10am to 1PM – Have fun at the show. Explore Lover's Lane Wildflower Walk that circles the Showgrounds. Take a 30min bus trip the Pindar Wreath Flowers
- * 1.30pm – Head back to Geraldton via scenic wildflower route.
- * 7.30pm - Casual Dinner at the Batavia Convention Centre (BCC). (140m walk from OCH)

Sunday 25th August

- * 6am to 8.30am – Breakfast at your Hotel.

Option 1—Moderate Drive

- * 10.00am to Midday – Depart for a scenic run through the Chapman Valley to the Nabawa Valley Tavern for lunch
- * 2pm – Depart Nabawa for a leisurely drive back to Geraldton via the historic town of Northampton.

Option 2—Long Drive

- * 9am—Depart for Kalbarri National Park & Skywalk via Port Gregory coast road and Kalbarri Townsite (193km)
- * 11am to 1pm—Take in the stunning views or enjoy a brew with view at the Skywalk Café.
- * 1pm Depart for Geraldton, via (Northwest Coastal Hwy) 180km
- * 8pm till Late – Gala Dinner (BCC)– Dance Band—Semi Formal. (140m)

Monday 26th August

- * 6am to 9.00am – Checkout .
- * 9am to 11am– Farewell Brunch at Geraldton Surf Lifesaving Club (short drive 3.4km)

National Rally Ticket Price—\$595.00 per person

Registrations will be open from January 31st 2024.

Access to discounted Hotel Rates open from January 31st 2024

HQ Ocean Centre Hotel



HMAS Sydney Memorial



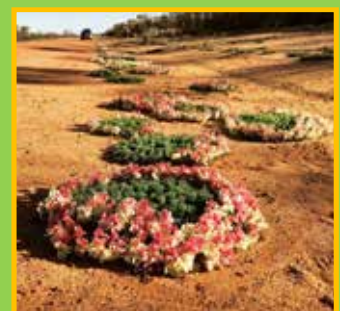
Midwest Wildflowers



90th Annual Mullewa Show



Wreath Flowers of Pindar



Kalbarri Skywalk





Historic Vehicle Registration News

If you have a car on Historic Vehicle Registration you should read this.

Your disorganisation does not mean my panic!

In case you didn't know, you have four months to renew the conditional registration of your car. The documentation is posted by Transport for NSW a month before it's due and if not renewed by the due date you will receive monthly reminders by post until the expiration of three months. If not renewed within the three months, the registration lapses.

Perhaps I am getting crotchety as I get older, but I see no reason why I should receive multiple phone calls on a Sunday night letting me know that a registration lapses

in four days, and it needs to be organised as a matter of urgency.

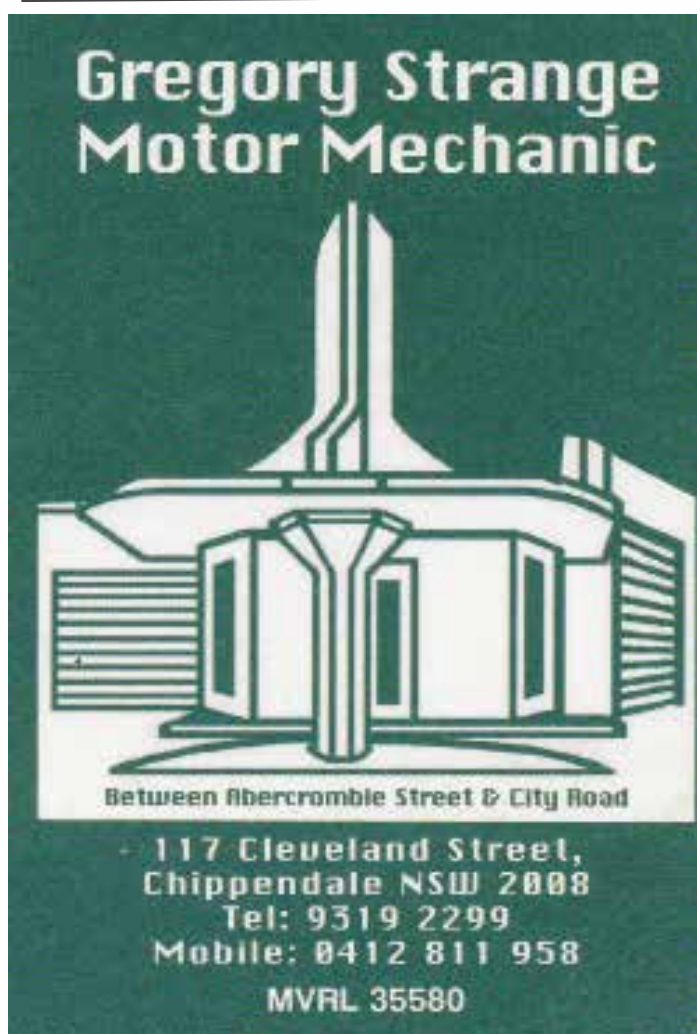
It is not up to me then run around like a chook, just because someone can't get their act together. So please when you receive the renewal from Transport for NSW don't file it away in a place where it's instantly forgotten. The process for renewing Conditional Registration is simple and requires just a modicum of timely organisation.

I have been including the steps for renewing Conditional Registration monthly for close to five years. That I continue to receive questions or time wasting like the above either means that some members don't read this page or worse still don't look at the *Flat Chat Newsletter* at all.

Please read as it's really straightforward:-

- Once you have received the renewal papers from Transport for NSW, arrange for your vehicle to be inspected for roadworthiness by either an Authorised Inspection Station or one of the volunteer AHOC inspection officers. See page 2 of this Flat Chat for their contact details. Remember all vehicles, including Historic vehicles need to be inspected and passed as roadworthy.
- Complete the left-hand side of the "Historic Vehicle Declaration" and post it to me at my home address (See page 2 of this Flat Chat for my address) along with an indication that your car is roadworthy or a copy of the pink slip. Please include a stamped self-addressed envelope. There is no need to send me the registration certificate. Do not post the documents by Registered Post as that just slows down the process as I have to go to the post office to accept a registered postal item.
- Once returned, either go to your local Services NSW office to do the renewal or post to Transport for NSW in Parkes. That address can be found on the registration papers.

DON'T FORGET THE STAMPED SELF-ADDRESSED ENVELOPE.



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Chapter News

Central Coast Chapter Workshop - 4 October



Once again the weather was with us here on the beautiful Central Coast. We held the November 4th workshop at Geoff Smith's home on Saint Huberts Island which proved to be a wonderful success.

Some 26 eager enthusiasts attended. The demo for the day - to refurbish two of the brass engine draintaps found on a six-cylinder car. Over the years the taps seize up and commonly you break off the tap handle. Unfortunately, I had left my demonstration taps in the boot of Jack's old 100 my choice of car for the day. However, with clear blue skies, I changed tack and fired up the Ross Bond 3000 instead.

I picked up Peter my neighbour from down the street, and had a leisurely drive to our morning's event not giving it a second thought of retrieving my demo.

All was not lost when Geoff came to the rescue and supplied me with the necessary equipment.

Tony Ash came south from Diamond Beach once again in his 3000 Mk2 Roadster. We were going to look at re-fitting his side curtains and adjust them to his hardtop, but he had already addressed the problem owing to the inclement weather on the way down and yes the rain stopped as he arrived on the Central Coast. We had



Central Coast cont'

12 Austin-Healeys on the day, we admired Geoff's car collection, consisting of a Bolwell Nagari, a PRB Clubman, BJ8 project and his very nicely restored MK1 3000.

Everyone really enjoyed themselves with morning tea on tap and the traditional coffee cookies and cake. We finishing up around 12:30 pm.

Attendees for the day were. Julie and Garry Lee BJ8, Larry Johns, Doug Ross, Vince Cessario BJ8, Allan Whitehouse BJ7, Geoff Smith 3000 Mk1, Jenny and Ross Penman BJ8, George and Liz Goodare, Scott

Parry-Jones 100/6, Jim Phillips 100/6, John Kirk, Neville Stirton, Richard Cardew Sunbeam Alpine, Ken Offord BJ7, Tony Ash 3000 Mk2, Mark and Stuart McAllan and Morgan Ayling BJ8, Jenni and Ian Richter BJ7, Kerrie and Colin Rule with guest Peter Howard Bond 3000.

By the time you read this the last workshop for the year scheduled for december 2nd at the Old Trading Post. 3718 Great North Road, Laguna will be over.

Stay safe everybody, take care and Happy Healey-ing. Col and Kerrie Rule.



Mid North Coast Chapter – November 18th

Our November meeting saw three Austin-Healeys and ten people present.

We started by reviewing Tony Ash's progress on the fitting of twin fuel pumps to his 3000 Mk 2. Previously we had relocated the brake junction block on the diff housing by shortening one brake pipe and making a longer new one. This gave Tony sufficient room then mount the two pumps side by side.

Previously I had found my old VHS recorder/player in the shed amongst the dust, hooked it up to the shed TV and surprise, surprise it still worked. I have old VHS tapes of Channel 7's coverage of the 1998 Bathurst Healey Races and also of Donald Healey's land speed record achievements with the 100 back in the early '50s on the Utah Salt Flats. I let these run throughout the meeting.

During coffee and cake we discussed the December meeting and agreed on a Christmas lunch at "River-view Restaurant" in North Haven, meeting at 11.a.m.

On the "TO DO" list for probably 12th December is some welding on the chassis of Chris Hatch's 100.

Merry Christmas and A Healey New Year from us all up here.

Cheers Phil Lorking



Cont next page

Chapter News cont'



AHOC Illawarra & Southern Highlands Chapters

PLOUGH & ALE HOTEL - 15th Nov 2023

It was a great day at the new Plough & Ale Hotel in Calderwood Valley. There was plenty of 'Christmas Cheer' and excited conversation between our 14 attendees. For me it was a real party feeling, as though we have come to the end of the year and achieved our goal of establishing great camaraderie between for Austin-Healey owners.

All up we have had 164 Austin-Healey people and friends attend our nine events during the year since the first event at the Historical Aircraft Restoration Society (HARS) Shellharbour Airport in March.

It was good to see another local member from the Kangaroo Valley area, Steve Crozier, was able to attend his first catch up and meet with our regular group. Steve is part owner of a "Healey Three-Litre Sports Convertible" with Richard Horwood.



David McIntyre tells me he brought the right car for a good nippy fun drive down Macquarie Pass in his very nimble and well handling 1964 Sprite Mk2. David has owned this car since 1984 and over the years has concentrated on the mechanical aspects of the car. It is a nimble quick sports car. I'm sure he had even more fun going back up the Pass. He says all it needs now is a coat of paint and is also in the process of working on his BJ8 gearbox.

Cont Next Page



Back L-R: FRan Thornton, Gerry South, Bruce Wallace, Steve Crozier, Colin Goldsmith, John Thornton Mark Righini, Peter Akhurst, Trevor Cowan, David McIntyre. Front Row: Tina Martin, Eileen Akhurst, Delwyn Goldsmith, Betty Bassingthwaite.

cont from prev page
Mark Righini (work ute) also from the Highlands made the decision to stay overnight in Wollongong, so he could make the luncheon.

The happy travellers Colin and Delwyn Goldsmith (sleek and beautiful Lexus LC 500) made the trip from Pitt Town. Colin and Delwyn have been the most regular, out of area supporters, to attend our chapter events and support the Club.

Gerry South (BN1) from Sanctuary Point threw caution to the wind (suspect weather conditions early in the day) to make the trip up the highway. Local

Austin-Healey owners, Bruce Wallace and Tina Martin (today in a nice metallic green VE Holden ute), Trevor Cowan and Betty Bassingthwaite (white BN4) Peter and Eileen Akhurst (blue over white BT7 Mk2) with Fran and myself (Ford Territory)

A Merry Christmas to all our members and look out for our first event in February 2024, The Tram Museum, 14th February.

Thank you to all the support for the year.

John Thornton





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AHOC Illawarra & Southern Highlands Chapters

2024 Events Calendar

Wednesday 14th February 2024 Tram Museum Loftus. Tram rides. Lunch at "Old Audley Dance Hall" Cafe in Royal National Park. Link: Ride a tram in Sydney Tramway Museum Link: Cafe Restaurant - Audley Dance Hall	Friday 15th March 2024. Bradman Museum. Bowral. Lunch at Burrawang Pub. Bradman Bradman Museum St Jude St, Bowral NSW, Australia Burrawang Village Hotel
Sunday 21st April 2024. Private Open House. Expansive Car Collection-South Coast. Picnic in the grounds. BYO food, drink, picnic tables. Tea, coffee, BBQ and facilities on site.	Wednesday 15th May 2024. The Berkelouw Book Barn located on Bendooley Estate. Link: Berkelouw Book Shop Bendooley Estate Berrima Southern Highlands Wedding Venue
Wednesday, Thursday, Friday 19th & 20th 21st June 2024. Three Day Getaway. Explore remaining sections of Old Hume H'way. Link: The Old Hume Highway: History begins with a road - WWDHS	Wednesday 17th July 2024 Motor Life Museum. Kembla Grange. Large collection of cars and memorabilia. Link: The Australian Motorlife Museum - The Australian MOTORLIFE Museum
Friday 16th August 2024. Retford Park tour of House, Gardens and The Ngunanggula Gallery. Lunch at the Gallery Café. Link: Retford Park - National Trust of Australia (NSW) - Destination Southern Highlands (visitsouthernhighlands.com.au)	Wednesday 18th September 2024 Joadja Historic Village. Full Historic Tour of the whole estate. Second trip. Link: ABOUT Joadja-Heritage (joadjatown.com.au)
Friday, Saturday, Sunday 18th, 19th & 20th October 2024 1. Goulburn Pump House & Steampunk Fair. 2. Your Choice? Make it a day trip. OR 3. Make it a weekend event. Drive down Friday with Fran and me. Stay Friday & Saturday night. a. Pump house operational all weekend. b. A big weekend festival. c. Steampunk Victoriana Fair. A real hoot! Link: Goulburn Historic Waterworks Museum (goulburnwaterworks.com.au) Link: Programme - Steampunk Victoriana Fair	Wednesday 20th November 2024 Christmas Lunch. Location TBA.

John Thornton

0419 266 284

Maude - The BN1 Project - Snippet Six – The Front Shroud

By Ian Richter

There has been a bit happening around Maude the BN1 project. The never-ending chassis work continues with the alignment of the left front wishbone mounts now complete. Next will be the front cross member, which has been repaired poorly in the past and will need to be replaced. With that work complete, it should see all the major chassis work done. The front, rear guards, doors and bonnet have all been stripped of paint and wasn't that a surprise! The highlight of that little exercise is the one door... is not bad. There are a few spots to hammer out, but it's rust free.

I am still working on the theory of keeping what is original; repairing, restoring or rejuvenating, and while most of us are constrained by budget and skill, when does this become uneconomical or just doesn't make sense to retain the piece you are labouring over?

The BN1 shroud is a mess. It's difficult to explain which parts of the shroud are worth keeping and what is scrap.

If you viewed an Austin-Healey shroud from the underside, (which is a lot easier off the car than on) you would notice that the complete shroud is made up of a number of shaped and formed aluminium parts all welded together. These are the scuttle top, left and right-side panels, and the four parts that make up the nose assemble.

The BN1 front shroud is a masterpiece of style, shaping the creativity that Gerry Coker penned for Donald Healey back in 1952. My shroud however was no masterpiece. I was pretty confident that the original scuttle top was salvageable, although it needed repair, but the rest - I was out of my depth. There were previous attempts of repair to prolong and retain the shape of the shroud. Some attempts were made with welded pieces of aluminium and others with bolted-on steel strengtheners. Someone in the past had a full go and a poor attempt at replacing the nose, which looked like a work in progress and was never going to have a reasonable conclusion.

I will borrow a catchphrase from the 1973 Dirty Harry movie *Magnum Force*, "A man's got to know his limitations," said as Dirty Harry watches Hal Holbrook get blown up in his police-issue Ford LTD. Now, I know any attempt by myself trying to repair the BN1 shroud would look like an exploded LTD. I do know my limitations regarding the work required to bring any resemblance of rescuing this aluminium front shroud. This is where I introduce you to Robbie.

Robert Siemsen is a classically trained coachbuilder and his business, based in Dubbo, offers both Australian and international clients contoured sheet metal work and traditional coachbuilding at its best. A couple of NSW Healey club members suggested I should give Robert a call to chat about rescuing the BN1 shroud. Robert is no stranger to the Austin-Healey, having completed works on a number of club members cars in the past. I successfully demonstrated my lack of knowledge in explaining over the phone, what I thought was required for the repair and he said "yes, sounds familiar, I have been here before. Bring out the shroud, and we will work with



Cont' next page

Shroud cont'

what we have and in the worst-case scenario, we can make a new one."



We had a two-day adventure getting the shroud to Dubbo and returning home. This was quite enjoyable, and even though Jennifer thought otherwise, it was not the main event. Robbie's workshop is like pulling up at any factory bay, nondescript and beige. It's when you walk inside and introduce yourself to Robbie (as he prefers to be called) there is nothing beige about the work and skill performed in this factory. His workshop is not cluttered; it's tidy, clean, structured, with the tools of his craft central to current projects. The walls are lined with templates for various vehicle panels, all clearly labelled and dimensioned. There is clear order in the space. The projects on the workshop floor range from a Ford F150 mid '50s rebody, a Jaguar XK 120 steel guard on the form under construction, which is a beautiful piece of work, a Jaguar E-type body, an Alfa and other projects.

I reluctantly drag Maude's front shroud off the ute. I'm almost too embarrassed to present my offering. I should just go with the new and skulk off back from where I came. Yet Robbie didn't even flinch. He walked me through his approach to tackle the previous repairs and get it back to factory spec, the new shroud nose was a no-brainer. A BN1 front shroud mould or hammer form that Robbie made some years back sits in the workspace. The quality of the

form was as impressive as a previously completed BN1 nose, which was hanging nearby.



Robbie's skill and capability have been developed over many years, both here in Australia and in the UK, the home of traditional coachbuilding. It would be extremely interesting to watch this young man perform his craft. I was not there for that, and I was

Cont' next page

Shroud cont'

conscious of his time I had already taken up.

A week after I dropped off the front shroud to him, I received an email and a series of photos. The work is progressing nicely.

Back to the Dirty Harry reference and particularly Clint Eastwood. Early on in Clint's career, he purchased an Austin-Healey 100 and possibly his first flash car as he rose to stardom. Unfortunately, it appears that he traded down to a Jaguar XK150 in about 1958. His loss!

Until the next update. Ian



Thanks to Will Sherman for sending in these photos of his 3000 Mk2 Roadster being delivered to him after the chassis, engine, gearbox and mechanicals had been refurbished at The Healey Factory.



A happy Will Sherman with his 3000 after it was delivered by Rob Rowland (in background)



In John Sherman's garage.



Will and 5 1/2 month old Evie Sherman enjoying the Austin-Healey.



The Opal Fossicker

Charlie's Run - 20-27 March 2024



Thank you to everyone who has already booked for the Opal Fossicker. You are the lucky ones as some of the motels are now full. However, all is not lost! If you would like to join us, the waitlist is now open. We often have a cancellation or two, dependent upon people's health and/or their cars.

So don't despair, if you would like to join in the fun of the run email Gordon and put your name on the wait-list



2024's Charlie's Run is going to **Lightning Ridge**. Not only are there black and other opals to be found, but the town also has thermal springs that feed two artesian bore **hot water pools**, so bring your bathers for a dip.

There are of course lots of opal themed things to do, see and buy as well as the **John Murray Art Gallery** and several opal **mining museums** including one built out of bottles, and that's all just within the township.

As usual we will take a reasonably relaxed tour, both to get there and to return. Our provisional schedule is as follows:

Wednesday, 20 March – Travel to Orange.

Thursday, 21 March – Orange to Gilgandra with a detour via the Orange wine region.

Friday, 22 March – Arrive at Lightning Ridge for a three-night stay to enjoy fossicking, exploring and checking out the opals and other delights.

Monday, 25 March - Depart Lightning Ridge for Gunnedah.

Tuesday, 26 March - Overnight at Denman, hopefully with a last night dinner included.

Wednesday, 27 March - Home.

This should mean that we will driving for three to four hours each day leaving time for a leisurely lunch and to have an afternoon stroll around each new town.

The cost of this run will be around **\$600 per person in a double or twin room, or around \$900 for a single room** for the seven nights' accommodation excluding meals.

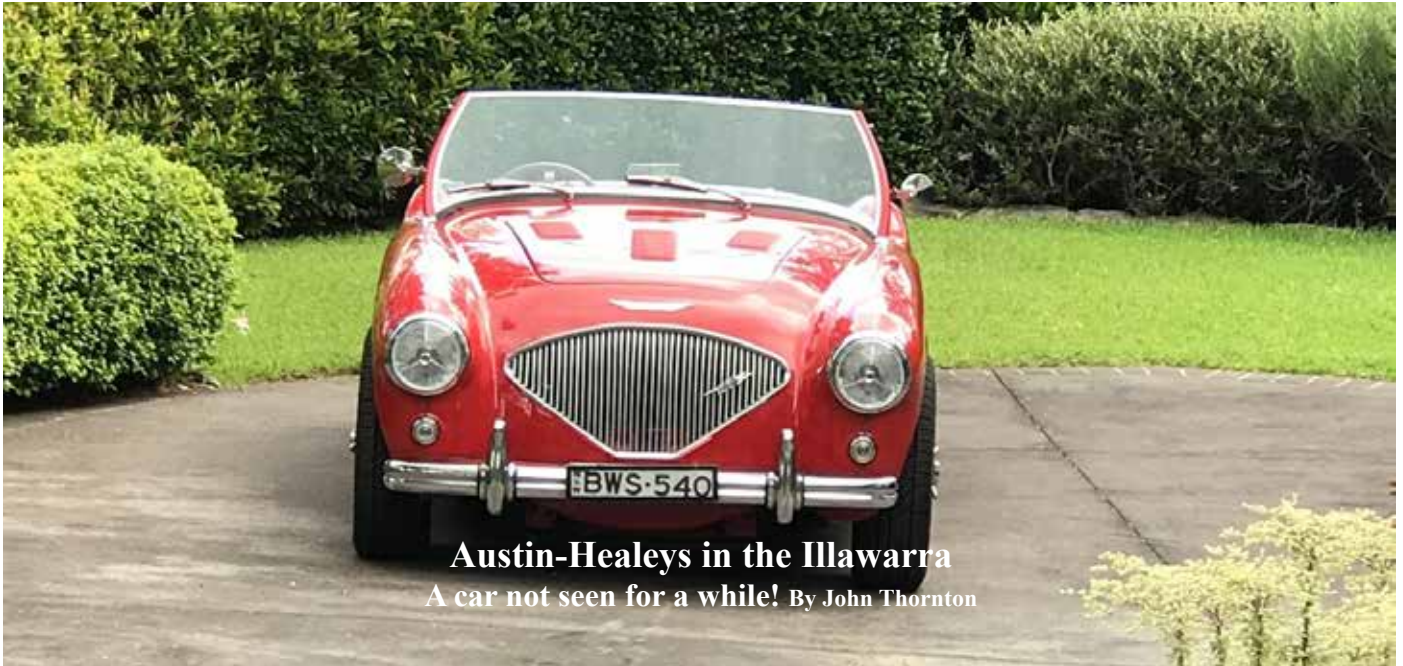


To register for the wait-list email or call Gordon (gordonl@aussiebb.com.au), or 0403 198 343). When a place becomes available, I will ask you to pay your \$50 deposit.

Westpac Bank: BSB 032 669, A/c no. 277411
'AHOC Charlies Run'

Happy Healeying,
Gordon Lynas





Austin-Healeys in the Illawarra

A car not seen for a while! By John Thornton

While talking with various Austin-Healey owners in the Illawarra recently, the name Dennis Norton entered our conversation as an owner in the region.

The information I received was rather limited, so it was time to get on the phone to other local Austin-Healey owners and find contact details for Dennis. (I should have completed reading my copy of "November 2023 Flat Chat" where coincidentally Dennis had placed a notice, listing various surplus Austin-Healey parts.)

I contacted Dennis, and a week later I was walking up the driveway, past a beautifully restored 1955 Austin-Healey 100 BN2. A few more steps and I was welcomed to Dennis and Dianne Norton's home.

Dennis purchased the car on the 8th September 1970 in Wollongong from Barry Anderson. Over the following years Barry used to place notes under the windscreen wiper when he saw the car around town; "I'm standing here crying! Don't forget, I have the first right of refusal". Dennis and Barry maintained a lifelong friendship.

As to the early history of the car, Dennis knows the first owner was the local Wollongong Austin Dealer and the car was driven by his daughter for about 12 months.

The car was then sold to an engineer (unknown) who mounted a towbar and towed a trailer to Western Australia and back. The towbar had been removed and the bumper bar refitted by the time Dennis purchased the car. By then the holes in the rear shroud were badly distorted and the rear bumper mounting brackets were badly deformed and cracked. These 'modifications' had been repaired before Dennis purchased the car.

Barry Anderson was the third owner, who purchased the car in 1960. He was a National Service conscript and was posted to Townsville, with the car spending time travelling the east coast between Wollongong and Townsville.

When Dennis purchased the car in 1970 it was fitted with a J & S fibreglass hardtop, and steel



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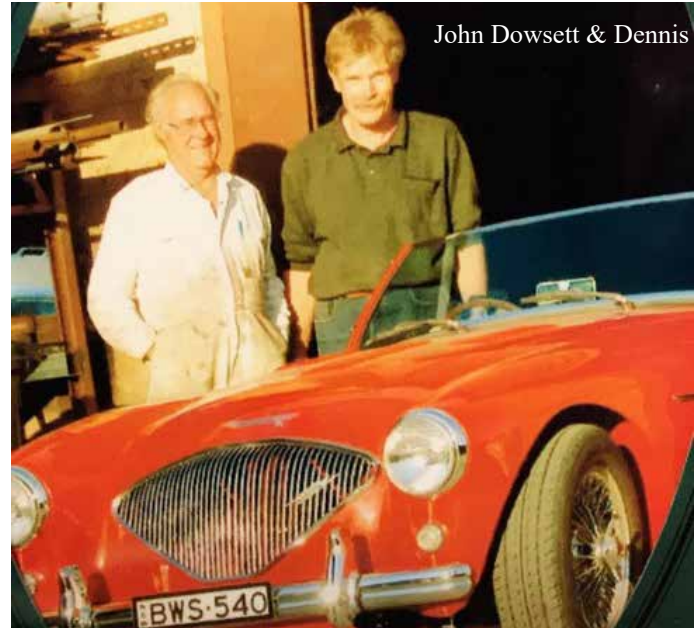
disc wheels. Dennis is aware the car was originally delivered with 48 spoke wire wheels, but these did not stand up the rigours of the Australian conditions or youthful drivers. Also, during previous ownership it had been fitted with wire wheels off Ron Thorpe's Cobra. They were not a success being oversize and extended past the body work, attracting much interest from the local constabulary! In 1972 Dennis painted the car 'white over green'.

The car was used regularly and when Dennis and Dianne married, it became Dianne's daily driver, transporting her to her job as a teacher. In 1974 Dennis and Dianne headed off overseas and the 100 was placed in Dianne's mothers' garage until the end of 1976 when they returned. The car came out of the garage in about 1978 with a view to getting it mobile again.

Dennis became heavily involved in the family company, "Illawarra Springs" when he returned from overseas, so in 1980 the car went back into Dianne's mother's garage.

In 1997 the car was again retrieved from the garage, and work commenced on the bodywork. By the 2000 the bodywork was completed by Cavanagh's Panel Works in Wollongong. The car is fitted with a fluted bonnet, with the original bonnet sitting in the garage.

The mechanical works commenced in 2000. John Dowsett, AHOC member and well known proprietor of the Classic Connection at Riverstone carried out the majority of the work and was responsible for completing the restoration and getting it back on the road. The car was fitted with an aluminium head and twin 1 ¾ SUs. With the mechanical works finished all that remained was the trimming.

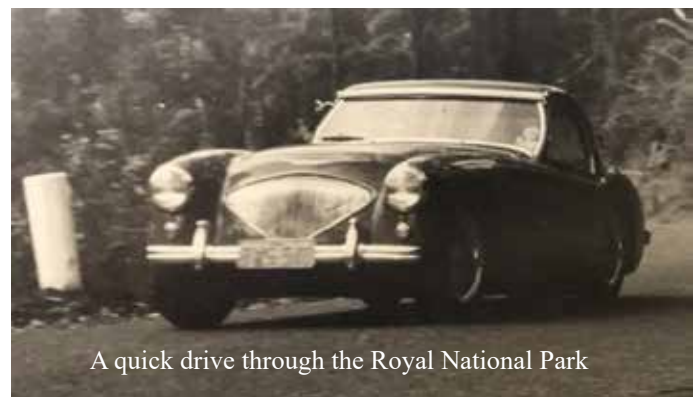


John Dowsett & Dennis

The restored car was re-registered on 1st May 2003. The original registration number BWS 540 in yellow and black and it now has the same number in black and white plates.

A quick drive through the Royal National Park. Anxious to get up the driveway and on the road. These days Dennis has the car out on a weekly "coffee" run with several of his friends.

And so, another young man's "Healey" passion satisfied.



A quick drive through the Royal National Park





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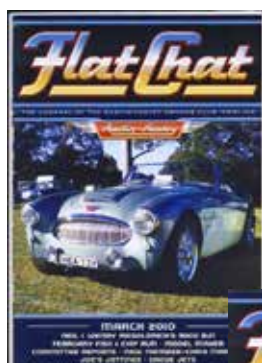
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Austin-Healeys at Sports Car Spares

By Patrick Quinn

A week or so back I received an email from Alwyn Keepence, the registrar for the AHOC of Queensland. He asked me if I knew anything about a six-cylinder Austin-Healey that he and a fellow AHOCQ club member had been eyeing with a view of buying it for restoration.

Receiving such requests about vehicle details come in fairly frequently from all over Australia and sometimes overseas.

Alwyn sent a photo of a car that clearly had seen better days. He also sent a few numbers they had been collected from the car. The numbers were an engine number of 29E/RU/H3610 and body number 3194 517.

It was wearing a 100/6 – 3000 Mk1 grille, but the engine under the bonnet was sporting triple SUs complete with all the paraphernalia you might expect to see on a 3000 Mk2 Roadster.

At the time of writing this, I have details on 1,718 Healeys and Austin-Healeys on my database and while a simple search didn't reveal the engine number at all, the body number did show itself.

When our cars were being manufactured, the body numbers for the four-cylinder cars and the 100/6 mostly consisted of two sets of digits or what's called the batch and body numbers. The first set indicates the batch the group of cars were in as they left Jensen and the second is the individual body number. With the 3000, the body numbering system changed to something that looked like 3024BT7XXXX.

So the car in question is a 100/6 BN4 manufactured as part of batch 3194 with the individual body number of 517. While easily changed, the grille did indicate that it was a 100/6 or 3000 Mk1.

What about the engine and triple SUs? Clearly the car has seen an engine swap sometime in its life. However the big giveaway was on the passenger side door, as it featured a lock and these were only fitted to Abingdon built 100/6s.

I was able to let Alwyn know what I had on the car, but I had something else and that was the notation that when I first received any information about the car the owner was Noel Anderson of 204 Toongabbie Rd., Girraween (a Sydney suburb) and that it was for sale on "eBay in January 2013 for \$32,000. In terri-

cont'

ble condition. Owned by Sports Car Spares.”

All of which takes me back to a date in 2012 when I was doing a price comparison for new six-cylinder engine components for the Quinn Austin-Healey. On one particular day I called in to Sports Car Spares to see Noel Anderson and what a treasure trove the place was. There was stuff everywhere for Austin-Healeys, MGs and Triumphs. The amazing thing was that everything was new, but such stuff like panels and other large components were out in the weather. Yes everything I needed was there and nothing was aftermarket, but new old stock.

As I walked in, I saw a six-cylinder Austin-Healey on my left facing away from me and it had triple SUs. I assumed that it was a Mk2 Roadster, but managed to find a number, as the bonnet was missing. It saddened me that the tyres were flat and its chassis

was slowly sinking into the muddy and oily ground. You can guess that the number was 3194 517. There was also a 100, but I was unable to get any numbers. Plus there was a very early BJ8 (BJ8L/25344). Interesting to note that the first BJ8 was BJ8/25315.

Anyway, I ended up not buying what I need, as I went elsewhere.

Sports Car Spares is no more and I understand that Noel Anderson retired to property near Marulan, south of Sydney, while his son moved to the Central Coast area. The NOS sports car spares? Don't know, but I have seen a few things come up on eBay advertised as coming from Sports Car Spares. Clearly a 100/6 has come up for sale in Queensland and I hear that the seller may know the whereabouts of a 100 and a very early BJ8.

FOR SALE

Silverstone bodied Healey

For sale is the Philip Bloom Silverstone bodied Healey. Chassis C1847 Engine B4888.

Following the sad loss of Philip Bloom in March, his son Lehman is offering his father's Healey for sale as part of the estate.

Originally built in a batch of ten on a suitably modified Healey chassis (Healey Abbott C1847) by Classic Restorations in the UK, this car is a tool room recreation of a Healey Silverstone. There were 105 Healey Silverstones built between 1949 and 1950.

It was purchased by Philip in 2015 and imported into Australia. Since then, it has been meticulously maintained by Daniel Kleinig.

As far as it's known, there are three Healey Silverstones in Australia plus two recreations. This car is one of the recreations.

Conditional Registration not transferrable.

For further information please contact Lehman Bloom on 0425 363 470.

FOR SALE

FOR SALE



Lucas Replacement Wiring Harness Smoke

Truthfully I have a lot of time for the Lucas components fitted to our Austin-Healeys. I have found that given the appropriate amount of maintenance and cleanliness all things work perfectly. That applies to everything in our cars, such as you wouldn't not service the engine correctly, so why not do the same for your car's electrics. Way back in the 1970s not long after I bought my first 100 the smoke did escape from the wiring spaghetti under the dash which led to me to find Fred Draper who had not long before-hand, started up AH Spares. By snail mail Fred said that could supply a new wiring harness and after it's trek to Australia it all went in without a problem.

If you are interested in motorsport from the '60s have a look at a photo or schematic of a Lucas mechanical fuel injection system – truly a work of art!

Having said all that, I came across the below written in the UK and while it's not new, I can't recall seeing the questions and answers before.

Patrick Quinn

Have you inadvertently let the smoke out of the wires on your classic British car? This, then, is the solution to your problem!

Here is presented for your perusal one Lucas Replacement Wiring Harness Smoke kit, P/N 530433, along with the very rare Churchill Tool 18G548BS adapter tube and metering valve. These kits were supplied surreptitiously to Lucas factory technicians as a trouble-shooting and repair aid for the rectification of chronic electrical problems on a plethora of British cars. The smoke is metered, through the fuse box, into the circuit which has released it's original smoke until the leak is located and repaired. The affected circuit is then rectified and the replacement smoke re-introduced. An advantage over the cheap repro smoke kits currently available is the exceptionally rare Churchill metering valve and fuse box adapter. It enables the intrepid and highly skilled British Car Technician to meter the precise amount of genuine Lucas smoke required by the circuit.

Unlike the cheap, far-eastern replacement DIY smoke



offered by the "usual suppliers", this kit includes a filter to ensure that all the smoke is of consistent size, It has been our experience in our shop that the reproduction Taiwanese smoke is often "lumpy", which will cause excessive resistance in our finely-engineered British harnesses and components. This is often the cause of failure in the repro electrical parts currently available, causing much consternation and misplaced cursing of the big three suppliers.

These kits have long been the secret weapon of the "Ultimate Authorities" in the trade, and this may be the last one available. Be forewarned, though, that it is not applicable to any British vehicle built after the discontinuing of bullet connectors, so you Range Rover types are still on your own...

This Genuine Factory Authorised kit contains enough smoke to recharge the entire window circuit on a 420 Jaguar, and my dear friend and advisor George Wolf of British Auto Specialty assures me that he can replace ALL the smoke in a W&F Barrett All-Weather Invalid Car(147 CC) with enough left over to test a whole box of Wind-Tone horns for



Smoke cont'

escaped smoke. How much more of an endorsement do you need?

More, you say? Well, I once let the smoke out of the overdrive wiring on my friend Roger Hankey's TR3B, and was able to drive over 200 miles home from The Roadster Factory Summer Party by carefully introducing smoke into the failed circuit WITHOUT even properly repairing the leak. Another friend, Richard Stephenson, was able to repair the cooling fan circuit of his Series 1 E-type by merely replacing a fuse and injecting a small quantity of smoke back into the wires. So there!

So, if you're troubled by lost smoke, bid early and bid often! Thanks for looking!

Here's a few of the 70 of questions asked!

Question & Answer

Q: I have a fourteen year old son named Lucas who I have caught several times in the back of the garage smoking. Can this item help him to respect a little firm parental intervention and aid him in smoking less...or even stopping altogether?

A: Part of the problem may be the fact that you named your son after the Prince Of Darkness. Mayhaps you should be happy that all you have caught him doing in the back of the garage is smoking! My suggestion is: since you already have spoiled him for life with his moniker, you search the 'Bay for a proper Little British Car to restore as a father-and-son project. That way, he'll have a way to fill the idle hours he'd have spent chasing girls had he been named Rocky or something more suitable. Plus, he'll learn first-handed how disgusting smoke can be. Alas, though, not with this unit, because whilst trying to photograph it for a spread in "Popular Ether Technology", it was unfortunately broken. Therefore, the auction must be terminated early. Thanks for the heartwarming interest!

Q: Once I have re-introduced smoke into my TR-2, do you warranty that it's system will resume operating at the speed of dark?

A: If you reintroduce the smoke through a microwave oven, you may even go back in time!

Q: I have been very diligent over the years and have maintained the smoke in my Sunbeam's wires perfectly. The problem is that that special Lucas perfume has disappeared from the dash, carpets and seats. In fact, at the last Concours d'Elegance I lost out to a frogeye with period odors. Is the smoke in your kit fresh enough to bring back the OEM smells of burning plastic and bakelite and are you including an adapter to replace same.

A: No adapter needed, but have you tried just STARTING that overrestored trailer queen? It might bring back the aroma by itself.

Q: This has been a most informative thread which set me off thinking about wider global environmental changes that have happened since the mid 70's. Could it be that the copious release of smoke from Lucas wiring looms around that time has significantly contributed to the holes in the ozone layer and the onset of global warming? Could it be that, had your excellent device been more available at that time, we could have saved the planet for future generations instead of fighting a rear guard action? Hindsight is such a wonderful thing isn't it.

A: Hey- This is a serious site- we're not discussing "junk science" like Global Climate Change!

Q: I have a question. For some time. My object is to restore a the few pre-Chrysler Rootes Sunbeam Tigers to original factory condition, with ALL the LAT racing options. So far, I have been quite successful, but unaware of your Lucas Smoke Kit. I am perplexed as to its satisfactory application to this original British Classic that Mr. Carroll Shelby has enhanced with a lot of Ford (USA) parts. This includes a large portion, but not all, of the electrics. It is very easy to differentiate between the Lucas Parts and the Ford Parts, as the Ford Parts still work. While we cn admire Mr. Lucas for the development of the intermittent windshield wiper, the self-dimming lighting system, and the colourful turn signal spark generator, it is unclear whether your offering will work satisfactorily with so much of the electrics originating in the US. Is this device compatible, as the US parts do not show signs of leaking smoke?

A: The Lucas smoke may cause failure



Smoke cont'
of the connecting interstices, but the, so will everything else.

Q: Maybe you can help me. I have an old generator that I have suspected of having a metaphysical ozone leak for several years. It's one of those things I feel I know to be true but cannot prove. Anyway, through an ingenious marriage of a Sharper Image Ionic Breeze air purifier and a breast milk pump, (by the way, both were obtained on eBay) I have devised a way to recharge the ozone that I can smell leaking from the generator. But, you guessed it, when I disconnect the wiring to introduce the replacement ozone I invariably cause a smoke leak. Do you think there is a way to mate our two machines in such a way that I could "kill two birds with a single stone" – if you will.

A: That's just wrong.

Q: Can I use this device to replace the smoke in my Alfa Spider? Is Brit smoke the same as Italian smoke?

A: Only if it's pre-Bosch.

Q: Will this kit put back ALL the smoke in a 1975 Midget wire harness? Some time ago while driving our 75 Midget smoke began pouring from under the hood, after pulling over, smoke was immediately followed by flames. A HUGE amount of smoke was lost from the wire harness (10 minute's worth before the fire department showed up). Your jar appears to be too small to contain the volume of smoke produced by the Midget on that day. Please specify quantity of smoke. PS - Would you know where can get bulk replacement glue on insulation, there is none left on any part of the wire harness under the hood. The harness appears to be intact but is lacking smoke holding insulation. I'm planning on rerouting the main power buss from over top of the fuel line. This way next time I will have smoke, red hot wires without melting thru the fuel line. Thanks in advance.

A: You'll need bulk smoke, but I'd try your last suggestion before ordering any. Good luck!

Q: Is this setup on the "metric system" or can it be used universally? I have a MB 380SL but

have replaced some of the wirings with U.S. products. Will your product make the transition? Also, are there any EPA limitations on shipping?

A: This setup is Whitworth only. sorry.

Q: As you may or may not know, the Japanese 'borrowed' heavily from British designs back in the 50's and 60's. In fact, the Skinner Union carbs on my beloved Datsun 1600 roadster were actually built by Hitachi under license. Also, most of the electrical devices in early Datsuns were copied from Lucas. That said, do you know if an adapter is available to use the Lucas Kit you offer on a Datsun 1600 or do I need to keep searching for the Hitachi/Mitsubishi version? Thanks, Paul

A: It sort of worked in my Datsun 410 Station Wagon, but the lights all shined in instead of out. It was quite disturbing...

Q: Does this unit contain new or re-cycled smoke and will it worked in my 1966 Triumph Bonneville motorcycle?

A: This is new, previously un-leaked smoke, as originally installed on your T-120.

Q: Would this product fix the Miller dynamo on my motorbike? The smoke got out of it years ago and I am in despair. Having to run a total loss electrical system now. Please, no smart-alec comments about nothing to lose. I have been desperate for a cure for years and will jump at anything. I get so depressed. But I really liked your answers to all the questions. I learned so much. You must be smart. What are some good upgrades for my bike? Should I get a Boyer electronic ignition?

A: Probably.

Q: It looks like a self-contained, auto smoking, environmentally enclosed, smoke recirculation, multi-smoker bong I created in the late 60s. The only thing missing is the air manifold (from a fish tank set-up) to hook up the individual smoking tubes. Are you sure you didn't get this idea from me, when we were smoking that wacky tobacco one time? ; >)

A: Could be. I can't remember.

Smoke cont'

Q: I have the identical part but needs the smoke refill cartridge, I was told to ring 84433 3-33888444555 or speed dial 666 is that you?

A: No, that's that shop in Michigan.

Q: Do you have any idea if the kit will work on Alfa Romeos? My 1963 Giulia has bullet connectors, a Lucas windshield wiper motor, and a variety of other Lucas components. Earlier Alfas had lots more Lucas stuff, such as starter motor and generator, so I imagine it's more suited to them. On a different note, did Alfa's change from Lucas to Bosch signify the end of the of the 'Italian masochistic' era?

A: This will work with the Lucas portions. The Bosch change was a misbegotten effort to work around the simultaneous Italian/British Steve-dore Strikes of the early 70s.

Q: Enough, enough! I cannot allow you to perpetuate this lowbrow fraud any longer! Anyone with any knowledge of Lucas products should recognize that the Lucas label art on the jar is wrong for this early version of the smoke kit. And of course, the lid should be black with the valve oriented 180° to the label. The smoke color itself is not original to the early cloth insulated wiring and perhaps even for the early plastic insulation. Bidders beware, this is most certainly a replica, and a poor one at that — possibly from Taiwan. Additionally, the smoke replacement kit was meant to be used only by highly qualified personnel. The dangers of misuse are indescribable - certainly I can't..., but the phrase "gone up in smoke" was born of this process.

A: Oh, yeah? well, in the interest of

openness, I'm going to place your tirade on the site. That doesn't mean I like it, though.

Q: I wonder if you would do an exchange (with a cash adjustment in my favour). I have some bottles of 'bottom air' that was supplied by Dunlop many years ago. The advantage is that it takes up very little space as of course when you get a flat the top air in the tyre remains perfectly serviceable, it's only the bottom air that needs replacing. I will wait your reply. All the best from the UK.

A: If this is the proper bottom air for a set of 4.00X 10 Gold Seals, we may be able to work a deal. We have a '68 Moke in the shop with original rubber, and the domestic bottom air keeps migrating out. It evidently doesn't have enough atmospheric British ambient smoke to fill the pores in the tyres.

Q: My brother Joe is currently (well last 8 years) working on a mini and he's never managed to get ANY smoke out of it yet. Would it be possible to use this kit to make some come out of other parts of the car - not just the wiring loom. I was thinking mainly about the exhaust...

A: No.

Q: Geez, I wish I had seen this auction before I bought some "off-shore" smoke. I didn't realize there was some OEM stuff left. To make matters worse, I switched to synthetic smoke (yeah, I know) but it seemed like the right thing to do at the time. Unfortunately for my 72 Range Rover, I have not yet been able to fashion an effective bypass for the optional Fairey smoke pump which has recently failed. If only you could have made this item available earlier!



Your Last Page



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**There are
several**

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**We meet on the first Thursday of the month at Strathfield Golf Club
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